

DS

DUKASAFE

Verified Commerce. Protected by Design.

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

MVP v1.0 — June 2026

CONFIDENTIAL

What is DukaSafe?

DukaSafe is a verified checkout and buyer-seller protection platform built for social media commerce in Kenya. Sellers on TikTok, WhatsApp, and Instagram share a DukaSafe link instead of a phone number. Buyers transact through a protected checkout. The platform acts as the intermediary — holding evidence, managing disputes, and building seller reputation over time.

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1. Executive Summary

DukaSafe addresses a well-documented and growing problem in Kenya's social commerce economy: buyers cannot verify that TikTok and WhatsApp sellers are legitimate, and genuine sellers have no credible way to prove they are trustworthy. The result is rampant payment fraud, order abandonment, and lost revenue for honest sellers.

DukaSafe solves this by inserting a verified, evidence-backed checkout layer between social media discovery and M-PESA payment. The platform is not a marketplace — it is a trust and protection infrastructure that social sellers plug into.

One-line pitch: DukaSafe is a verified checkout and buyer-seller protection platform for social media commerce, allowing customers to buy safely from TikTok, Instagram, and WhatsApp sellers while protecting genuine sellers from false claims.

2. Brand Identity & Design Language

2.1 Name & Tagline

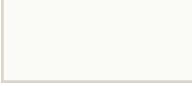
Field	Value
Product Name	DukaSafe
Tagline	Verified Commerce. Protected by Design.
Category	Social Commerce Trust & Escrow Platform
Primary Market	Kenya — Social media sellers on TikTok, WhatsApp, Instagram
Stage	MVP v1.0

2.2 Naming Rationale

'Duka' is the Swahili word for shop — immediately recognisable and culturally grounded for a Kenyan audience. 'Safe' communicates the core value proposition in a single English syllable understood across the market. Together, DukaSafe means 'a safe shop' — a checkout you can trust.

2.3 Brand Colour Palette

Swatch	Name	Hex	Usage
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	Forest Green	#1A3C34	Primary brand, headers, CTA buttons
	Sage Green	#4A7C6F	Secondary UI, sub-headings, links
	Amber Gold	#C8965A	Accents, highlights, verified badge
	Warm Sand	#F5F0E8	Section backgrounds, card fills
	Charcoal	#2D2D2D	Body text, icons
	Off-White	#FAFAF7	Page background

2.4 Typography

Primary typeface: Inter (web) / Arial (document fallback). The typographic system follows a clean, modern hierarchy that communicates professionalism and trustworthiness — essential for a platform where credibility is the core product.

Role	Weight / Style	Size (web)
Brand Wordmark	Bold	36–48px
Page Titles / H1	SemiBold	28–32px
Section Headers / H2	SemiBold	22–24px
Card Labels / H3	Medium	16–18px
Body Text	Regular	15–16px
Captions / Labels	Regular	12–13px

2.5 Logo Mark

The DukaSafe logo mark is the monogram 'DS' set in bold against the Forest Green primary. The full logotype pairs 'DUKASAFE' in uppercase Inter SemiBold with the 'DS' shield emblem. A verified badge variant (green circle + gold checkmark) is used throughout the platform as the trust signal for approved sellers.

2.6 Design Principles

- Clarity first — every screen communicates trust status immediately
- Mobile-native — the primary interface is a smartphone screen; tap targets are generous
- Warm minimalism — sand and forest tones feel professional without being cold

- Evidence-forward — proof, verification, and dispute states are always visible
- Bilingual-ready — UI copy should support both English and Swahili from day one

3. Problem Statement

Kenya's social commerce ecosystem is large, active, and largely unprotected. Thousands of small sellers use TikTok, WhatsApp, and Instagram to reach customers — posting products, collecting orders via DM, and requesting M-PESA payment to a phone number. This model has three critical failure points:

1. Buyers cannot verify seller identity. There is no way to confirm that a TikTok clothing seller is legitimate before sending money.
2. M-PESA is irreversible once funds are used. Safaricom can only reverse a transaction if the recipient has not spent the funds — meaning fraud is usually unrecoverable.
3. Genuine sellers have no credibility infrastructure. A real seller with 500 happy customers has no way to prove it to a new buyer. Their trust score lives in DMs and screenshots.

Real example: A buyer paid KSh 1,800 to a TikTok clothing seller. The seller confirmed receipt, then stopped responding. Safaricom was unable to reverse the payment. DCI and police involvement was required — for a KSh 1,800 purchase.

This is not an edge case. It is the default experience for social commerce in Kenya. DukaSafe eliminates this by inserting a verified, evidence-backed checkout layer between discovery and payment.

4. Solution Overview

4.1 Core Concept

DukaSafe provides social media sellers with a verified profile and a safe checkout link. Instead of posting their M-PESA number, a seller posts their DukaSafe link. Buyers open the link, see verified seller credentials, place an order through a structured checkout, and pay through the platform. The platform holds the transaction record, manages delivery confirmation, and arbitrates disputes.

The flow: Seller posts TikTok video → Buyer clicks DukaSafe link → Sees verified profile → Places structured order → Pays via M-PESA checkout → Seller dispatches → Delivery confirmed → Seller paid. If anything breaks: dispute process with full evidence trail.

4.2 What DukaSafe Is Not

- Not a marketplace — DukaSafe does not host product catalogues or replace TikTok/WhatsApp as a discovery platform
- Not a bank or payment processor — DukaSafe does not hold funds at MVP stage; it tracks and evidences transactions
- Not a scammer-exposure platform — DukaSafe builds trust for genuine sellers, not a public blacklist

5. User Personas

5.1 The Social Seller (Primary Seller Persona)

Field	Details
Name	Aisha, 24, Nairobi
Channels	TikTok Shop, WhatsApp Business
Products	Imported clothing, cosmetics, electronics accessories
Pain points	Buyers ghost after asking prices; no way to prove legitimacy; fake dispute claims from buyers
Goal	More completed orders; a profile she can share that proves she is real and trustworthy
DukaSafe value	Verified badge, safe checkout link, seller protection, dispute evidence

5.2 The Cautious Buyer (Primary Buyer Persona)

Field	Details
Name	Brian, 29, Nakuru
Behaviour	Browses TikTok for fashion; wants to buy but has been scammed before
Pain points	Cannot tell real sellers from scammers; M-PESA is irreversible; no recourse after fraud
Goal	Know the seller is real before paying; have somewhere to complain if things go wrong
DukaSafe value	Verified seller profile, buyer protection, structured dispute process

5.3 The Platform Admin (Internal Persona)

Field	Details
Role	DukaSafe operations staff
Responsibilities	Seller ID verification, dispute mediation, trust score management, suspicious activity monitoring
Tools needed	Admin dashboard with queue view, seller documents, order timeline, dispute thread, trust score controls

6. MVP Scope — Version 1.0

The MVP is deliberately narrow. The goal is to validate core demand — that social sellers will register, that buyers will use the checkout link, and that the dispute process works — before adding complexity.

6.1 Screens in Scope (6 Core Screens)

Screen	Purpose	Primary User
1. Landing Page	Value proposition, seller sign-up CTA, buyer trust signals	All
2. Seller Registration	ID upload, shop details, social account linking, agreement to terms	Seller
3. Public Seller Profile	Verified badge, shop info, trust score, completed orders, refund policy	Buyer
4. Create Order / Product Link	Seller creates a specific order or product checkout link to share	Seller
5. Buyer Checkout / Order Page	Order details, delivery info form, M-PESA payment confirmation	Buyer
6. Admin Dashboard	Seller verification queue, dispute management, trust score controls	Admin

6.2 Buyer-Side Features

- View verified seller profile with badge, score, and completed order count
- View product / order page with item details, delivery terms, and refund policy
- Enter delivery details (name, location, delivery method preference)
- Upload M-PESA payment confirmation screenshot
- Track order status: Pending → Paid → Dispatched → Delivered → Closed
- Raise a dispute if item is not delivered, is incorrect, is counterfeit, or seller disappears
- Receive dispute resolution notification

6.3 Seller-Side Features

- Register shop with ID / passport upload, shop photos, social media account links
- Accept DukaSafe seller terms and refund / dispute policy
- Create a product or order checkout link to post on TikTok / WhatsApp
- View incoming orders and buyer details
- Mark order as dispatched and upload delivery proof (photo, tracking, rider confirmation)
- Receive delivery confirmation OTP from buyer
- Respond to disputes with counter-evidence
- View own trust score and review history
- Blacklist abusive buyers (subject to admin approval)

6.4 Admin-Side Features

- Review and approve or reject seller registration applications
- View all transactions and orders across the platform
- Open and manage dispute cases with full evidence timeline
- Assign or adjust seller trust scores
- Suspend or permanently ban sellers for policy violations
- Export transaction logs for record-keeping

7. Functional Requirements

7.1 Seller Verification Flow

4. Seller submits registration form with: full name, phone number, ID / passport scan, shop name, business location, shop photos, social media profile links, M-PESA number or Paybill
5. System sends OTP to submitted phone number for verification
6. Admin reviews submission in dashboard within 24–48 hours
7. Admin approves (grants verified badge) or rejects (sends reason)
8. Approved seller can generate checkout links immediately

7.2 Order Flow

9. Seller creates an order link: item name, description, price, delivery terms, refund policy
10. Seller shares link on TikTok / WhatsApp / Instagram
11. Buyer opens link, views seller profile and order details
12. Buyer fills in: name, delivery address, phone number, delivery method
13. Buyer pays via M-PESA and uploads payment confirmation screenshot

14. Order status moves to: Paid
15. Seller sees payment confirmation, marks order as Dispatched, uploads delivery proof
16. Buyer receives delivery, enters OTP or confirms receipt
17. Order closes; seller trust score incremented

7.3 Dispute Flow

18. Buyer raises dispute within the allowed window (default: 24 hours after marked Delivered)
19. Buyer submits dispute type: Not Received / Wrong Item / Counterfeit / Other
20. Buyer uploads supporting evidence: screenshots, photos, chat logs
21. Platform notifies seller; seller has 48 hours to respond with counter-evidence
22. Admin reviews both sides and issues resolution: Refund / Partial Refund / Dismissed
23. Resolution logged permanently on both buyer and seller records

7.4 Trust Score System

Trust Score is a 0–100 integer assigned to each seller. It is calculated from the following weighted signals:

Signal	Weight	Notes
Completed orders (no dispute)	40%	Primary indicator
Verified ID on file	20%	Binary: verified or not
Dispute win rate	20%	Disputes found in seller's favour
Response time to buyer messages	10%	Tracked via platform
Account age	10%	Older accounts score higher

Trust Score bands displayed to buyers:

- 90–100: Elite Seller badge (gold)
- 70–89: Trusted Seller badge (green)
- 50–69: Verified (blue) — standard verification only
- Below 50: Under Review (no badge shown)

8. Technical Architecture

8.1 Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Rationale
Frontend	React / Next.js (PWA)	Fast build, SEO-friendly, works offline on mobile
Backend & Database	Supabase (PostgreSQL)	Auth, real-time, storage, Row Level Security built-in
Authentication	Supabase Auth (OTP via SMS)	Phone-first auth matches Kenyan user behaviour
File Storage	Supabase Storage	ID scans, shop photos, payment screenshots, dispute evidence
Payments v1	Manual M-PESA screenshot upload	Avoids licensing complexity at MVP stage
Payments v2	M-PESA Daraja STK Push (Safaricom API)	Automated push payment once licensed
Hosting	Vercel	Zero-config Next.js deploy, global CDN, free tier sufficient for MVP

8.2 Core Database Tables

Table	Key Fields	Notes
users	id, phone, role (buyer/seller/admin), created_at	Supabase Auth UID
sellers	user_id, shop_name, id_scan_url, verified, trust_score, social_links	Extended seller profile
products	id, seller_id, name, description, price, delivery_terms, refund_policy	Order link source
orders	id, product_id, buyer_id, status, payment_proof_url, delivery_proof_url	Full order lifecycle
disputes	id, order_id, raised_by, type, evidence_urls, status, resolution	Dispute management
reviews	id, order_id, buyer_id, seller_id, rating, comment	Post-delivery feedback

8.3 Non-Functional Requirements

- Mobile-first responsive design — minimum viewport 320px
- Page load time under 3 seconds on 3G connection
- All uploaded files stored with access control (private by default, shared only on need)

- OTP phone verification on all account creation flows
- All dispute evidence immutably timestamped on upload
- Admin actions (approve, ban, score change) logged with operator ID and timestamp

9. Screen Specifications

9.1 Landing Page

Purpose: Communicate trust, explain value to both sellers and buyers, drive seller sign-up.

Key sections:

- Hero — headline ('Buy safely. Sell confidently.'), verified seller mockup, dual CTA buttons: 'Verify My Shop' (seller) and 'Check a Seller' (buyer)
- How It Works — 3-step visual for buyers and 3-step for sellers
- Trust signals — stats: verified sellers, protected orders, resolved disputes
- Seller testimonials — social proof carousel
- Footer — links to Terms, Refund Policy, Dispute Charter, Contact

9.2 Seller Registration Page

Multi-step form. Step 1: Phone OTP. Step 2: Personal details + ID upload. Step 3: Shop details + social links. Step 4: Agree to Seller Terms. Step 5: Confirmation screen with '24–48hr review' message.

9.3 Public Seller Profile

The public-facing page buyers land on from a seller's shared link. Contains:

- Verified badge and trust score band (colour-coded)
- Shop name, location, WhatsApp contact (masked until order placed)
- Delivery regions and estimated timeframes
- Refund policy (displayed as plain-language summary)
- Completed order count and average rating
- Recent verified reviews
- CTA: 'Shop Safely' — links to active product / order pages

9.4 Create Order / Product Link Page

Seller-only. Fields: item name, description, photos, price (KSh), delivery options, refund window, special notes. Output: a shareable URL the seller posts on social media. Link previews show item thumbnail, seller name, and verified badge.

9.5 Buyer Checkout / Order Page

Buyer-facing. Displays item, price, seller profile summary. Buyer fills in: full name, phone, delivery address, delivery preference. Pays M-PESA to the DukaSafe Paybill number (or manually uploads screenshot at MVP). Receives SMS confirmation and order tracking link.

9.6 Admin Dashboard

Three primary tabs:

- Verification Queue — pending seller applications with document viewer, approve / reject controls
- Orders & Transactions — full order list, filterable by status, seller, and date range
- Disputes — active disputes with timeline, evidence viewer, resolution form, and precedent notes

10. Revenue Model

Revenue Stream	Rate	Notes
Transaction fee	3–7% per order	Charged to seller on order completion
Seller verification fee	KSh 300–1,000 one-time	Covers ID review process
Premium seller badge	KSh 500/month	Featured placement on directory
Buyer protection fee	KSh 50–100 per order	Optional buyer-paid insurance
Delivery partner commission	5–10% of delivery fee	If integrated with riders
Monthly subscription (high-volume)	KSh 2,000–5,000/month	Unlimited orders + priority support

Example: At 5% transaction fee on 1,000 orders per month at average KSh 1,500 each — platform earns KSh 75,000/month from transaction fees alone, before verification fees or subscriptions.

11. Legal & Compliance Considerations

DukaSafe operates at the intersection of financial transactions, identity verification, and consumer protection. The following compliance areas must be addressed before full public launch:

Area	Requirement	MVP Approach
Payment regulation	CBK licences mobile money and payment service providers under the National Payment System Act	MVP avoids holding funds; route via existing licensed PSP
Data protection	ODPC requires registration as a data controller when collecting personal data (IDs, phone numbers)	Register with ODPC before collecting user data
Consumer protection	Kenya's Consumer Protection Act governs unfair trade practices in consumer transactions	Clear refund policy and dispute charter published at launch
KYC / AML	Seller ID verification constitutes basic KYC	Manual review at MVP; automated checks in v2

Recommended approach for MVP: partner with a licensed payment provider (e.g. Pesalink, IntaSend, or DPO) rather than holding funds directly. Frame the MVP as 'verified checkout + dispute evidence + payment tracking' — not full escrow. Seek legal advice before v2 escrow feature.

12. Go-to-Market Strategy

12.1 Launch Target Segment

Phase 1 target: TikTok and WhatsApp fashion / clothing sellers in Nairobi with existing follower bases (1,000–50,000 followers). These sellers have active buyers but no trust infrastructure. They are motivated by credibility and order completion rates.

12.2 Seller Acquisition

- Direct outreach to TikTok clothing sellers via comment / DM: 'Your store qualifies for a free verified DukaSafe badge'
- Partner with iHub and Nairobi startup community for warm intros
- Referral programme: verified seller refers another seller, both earn trust score bonus
- Target first 20 sellers manually — verify, onboard, and support in person

12.3 Buyer Acquisition

Buyers arrive organically through seller links. No separate buyer acquisition spend needed at MVP stage. The seller's TikTok audience is the buyer pipeline. Each verified seller link is a marketing touchpoint.

12.4 Expansion Roadmap

Phase	Target	Key Addition
MVP (Now)	20 sellers, 200 orders	Manual verification, screenshot payment, 6 core screens
v1.5 (Month 3)	100 sellers, 1,000 orders	M-PESA Daraja STK Push, seller directory, mobile app
v2 (Month 6)	500 sellers, 10,000 orders	Full escrow, delivery partner integration, bulk seller tools
v3 (Year 2)	National scale	Electronics, beauty, food — all social commerce verticals

13. Success Metrics — MVP KPIs

Metric	Target (Month 1)	Target (Month 3)
Sellers registered	20	100
Sellers verified	15	80
Orders placed via DukaSafe links	50	500
Order completion rate (no dispute)	> 85%	> 90%
Dispute resolution time	< 72 hours	< 48 hours
Buyer repeat order rate	—	> 30%
Average seller trust score (verified)	> 65	> 72

14. Out of Scope — MVP v1.0

- Native Android / iOS applications (PWA only at MVP)
- In-app messaging between buyer and seller
- Full escrow with fund holding (licensing dependency)

- Automated M-PESA STK Push (v1.5 target)
- Product catalogue / discovery browse (not a marketplace)
- Multi-vendor cart checkout
- Seller analytics dashboard
- API for third-party integrations

15. Open Questions & Decisions Pending

Question	Options	Decision Owner
Payment partner for v1.5	IntaSend, DPO, Pesalink, Safaricom Daraja	Founder
ODPC registration timing	Before MVP launch vs. at 100 users	Legal advisor
Seller verification fee	Free for first 50 / KSh 500 standard	Founder
Dispute window duration	24 hours vs. 48 hours post-delivery	Product
Trust score visibility	Show exact number vs. band only	Product / UX
Admin staffing at launch	Founder manual vs. part-time hire	Founder

16. Appendix

16.1 Glossary

Term	Definition	Context
DukaSafe Link	A verified, shareable checkout URL generated by a seller	Core product unit
Verified Badge	Visual trust signal awarded after ID review and approval	Displayed on seller profile
Trust Score	0–100 integer reflecting seller reliability	Computed from order history
Dispute Window	Time period after delivery in which a buyer can raise a dispute	Default 24 hours
STK Push	Safaricom API-triggered M-PESA payment request sent to buyer's phone	Planned for v1.5
KYC	Know Your Customer — identity verification of sellers at registration	Compliance requirement
Escrow	Holding of buyer funds until delivery confirmed	Out of scope at MVP

16.2 Document Control

Field	Value
Document Title	DukaSafe MVP Product Requirements Document
Version	1.0
Date	June 2026
Author	Fredrick Njoroge Kariuki
Status	Draft — For Internal Use
Next Review	After first 20 seller onboardings